

~40%

Sales growth, last 12–18 months
client-reported trend

+34%

Jan–Sep 2025 vs. Jan–Sep 2024
estimated from monthly chart

–3%

Sep 2025 vs. Sep 2024
first year-over-year dip in 3 years

59%

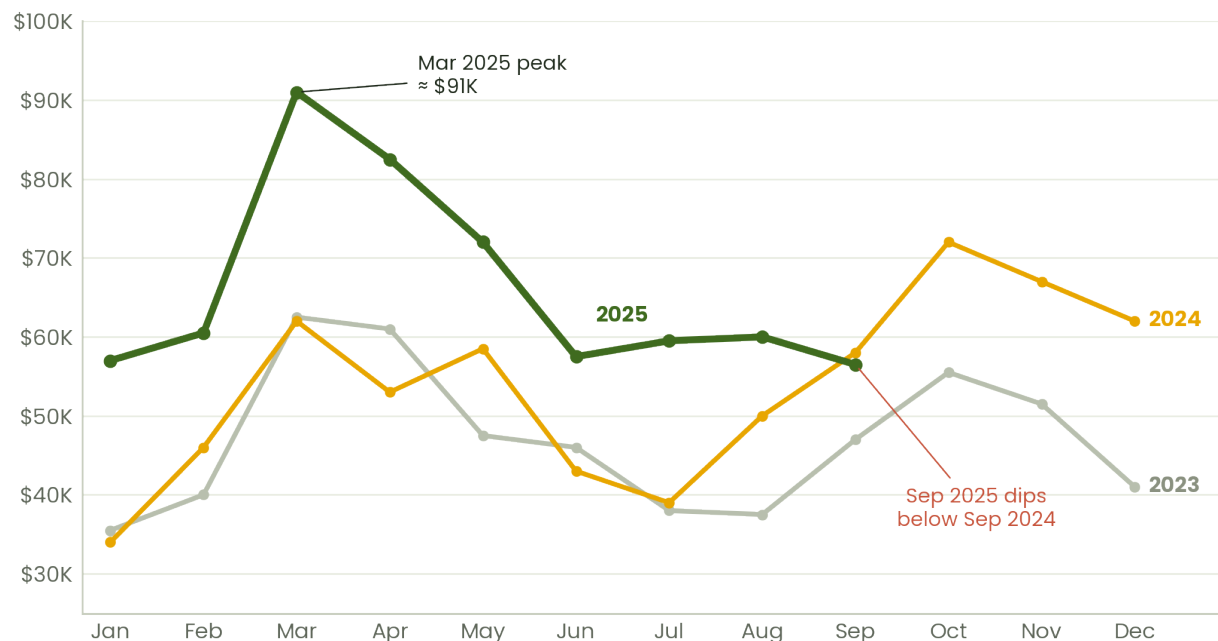
of identified-customer revenue
comes from 27 Active customers

927

Gold Buckle + Pulled Pork
most common pairing of 2025

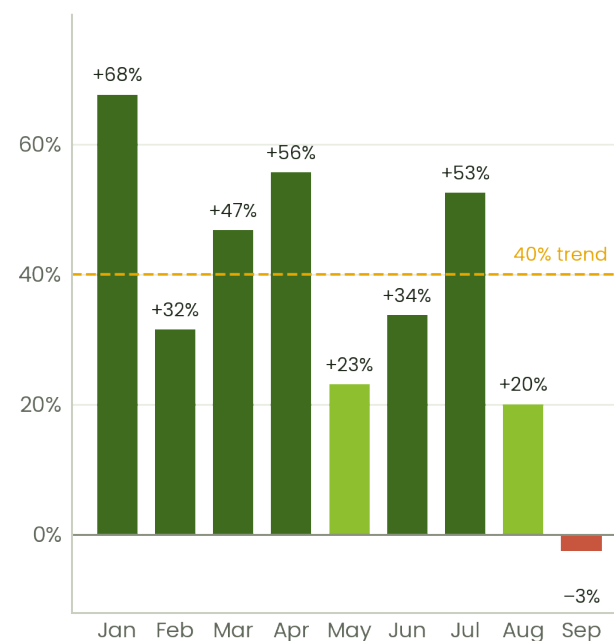
Monthly net sales by year

Same seasonal shape each year — 2025 lifts the whole curve



2025 growth vs. same month 2024

Deceleration begins in August



INTERPRETATION

- Growth is real, but it is decelerating.** Every month from January to July 2025 beat 2024 by roughly 23–68%. August slipped to about +20%, September to about –3%, and the client reports October at +13% — a recovery, yet still far below the 40% run rate.
- The calendar has a stable shape.** Three years show the same pattern: spring (Mar–Apr) and fall (Oct–Nov) peaks with a June–August trough. 2025 raised the level without changing the shape, so planning by season is safe.
- Part of the slowdown is arithmetic.** Fall 2024 was itself up 23–51% on fall 2023, so late-2025 months are measured against a much harder base. A smaller percentage is not automatically a demand problem.

ABOUT THIS DASHBOARD

Question. Which factors explain the growth, and how much does each matter?

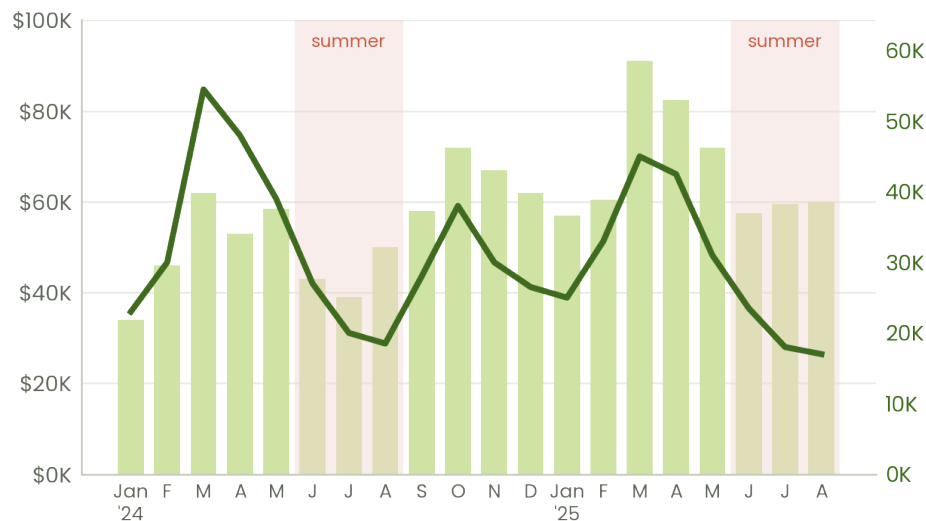
Sources. Square POS (primary), National Park visitor counts, Phoenix gas prices, customer directory. Instagram, Facebook, Mailchimp and Yelp were collected but not yet analysed.

Pages. 2 External drivers · 3 Menu & product mix · 4 Customers · 5 Integrated view, actions and data caveats.

Montezuma Castle visitors

Jan 2024 – Aug 2025 · line = monthly visitors

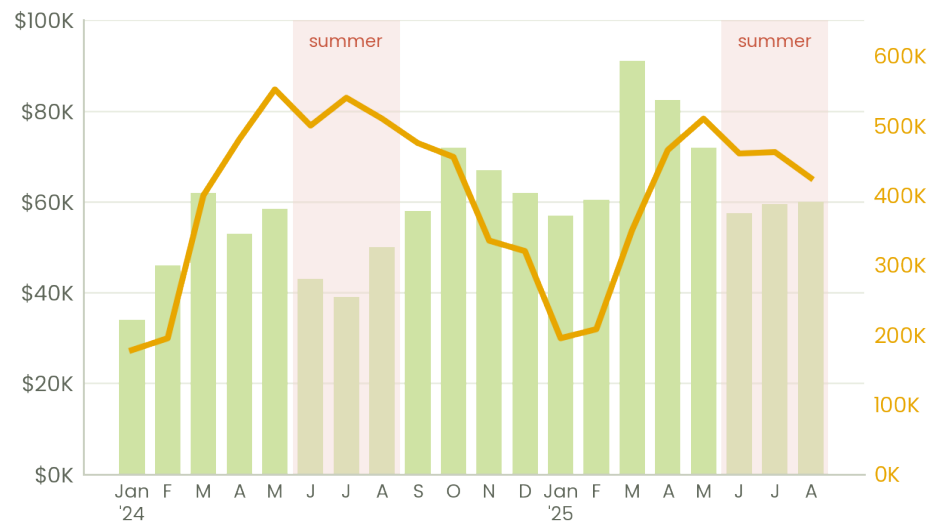
$r \approx 0.5$ · moderate



Grand Canyon visitors

Jan 2024 – Aug 2025 · line = monthly visitors

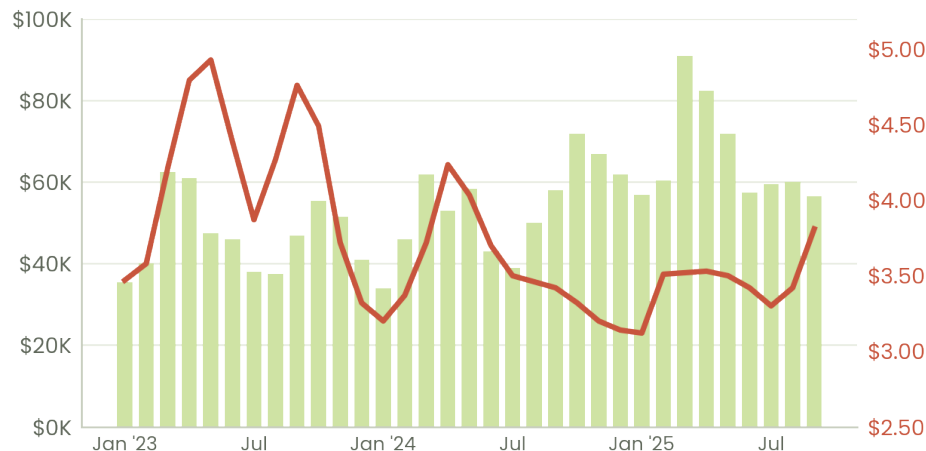
$r \approx 0.1$ · weak



Phoenix average gas price

Jan 2023 – Sep 2025 · line = regular, \$/gal

$r \approx -0.15$ · no clear link

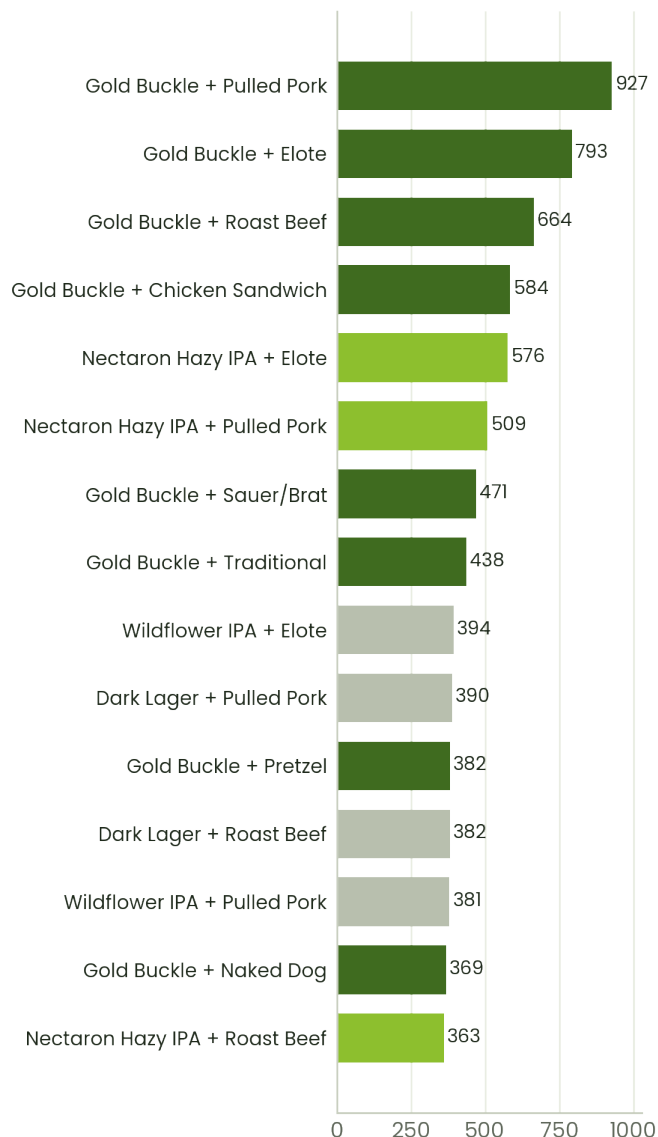


INTERPRETATION

- **Montezuma Castle is the better barometer.** It sits in Camp Verde itself, and its spring and fall peaks line up with Verde's ($r \approx 0.9$ within 2025). Use its calendar for staffing and events.
- **The Grand Canyon moves on a different clock.** Its visits peak May–August, exactly when Verde's sales trough. It signals regional traffic, not monthly sales, so the fire's effect is hard to isolate here.
- **Tourism explains the shape of the year, not the growth.** Jan–Aug visits were about 8–10% lower in 2025 at both parks while sales rose ~34%. The growth comes from capturing more per visitor and from locals.
- **Gas prices: watch, don't act.** 2025's gains came at a flat ~\$3.50. September's jump to ~\$3.81 coincides with the dip, but that is one data point.

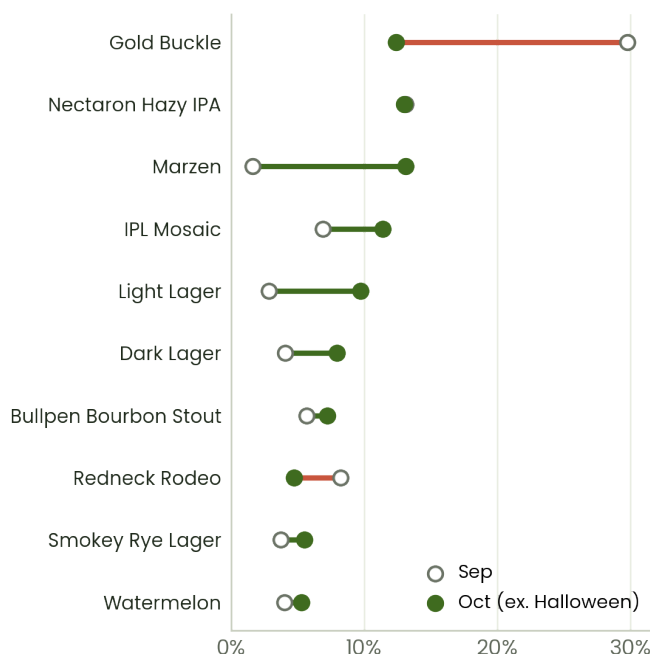
Top 15 food + beer pairings, 2025

Items sold together · dark = Gold Buckle, lime = Nectaron



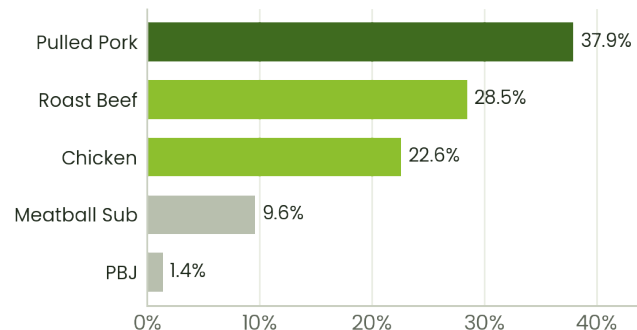
Share of pint revenue: September to October

Hollow = September, solid = October (ex. Halloween)



October sandwich sales

Share of sandwich gross sales

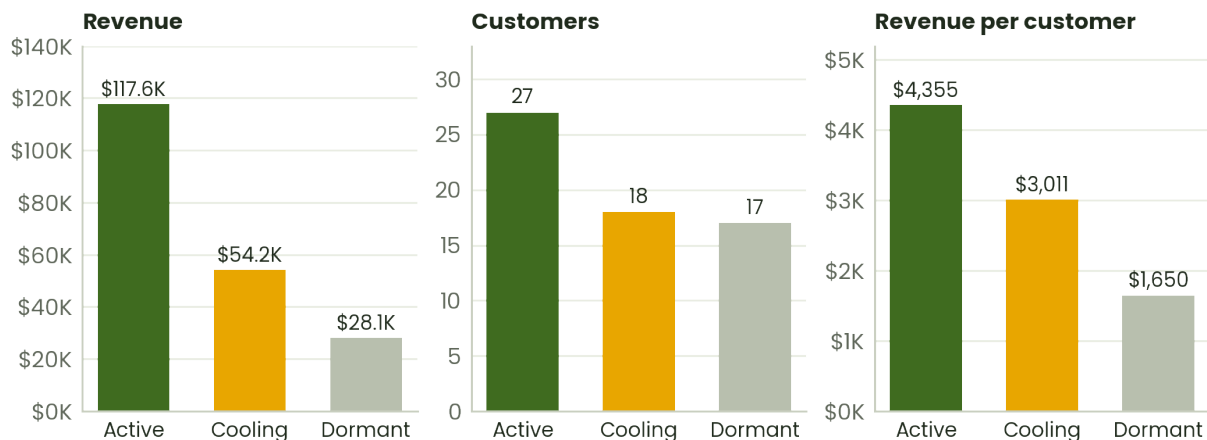


INTERPRETATION

- **Gold Buckle is the anchor.** It appears in 8 of the top 15 pairings and earned ~30% of September pint revenue. Pulled pork, elote and roast beef are the food anchors — they pair well with every leading beer.
- **Nectaron Hazy IPA is the steady number two.** It held ~13% of pint revenue in both months and appears in 3 of the top 15 pairings.
- **October broadened the mix and grew the total.** Gold Buckle fell from 594 to 294 pints (29.8% to 12.4% of pint revenue), while Märzen (30 to 289), Light Lager (61 to 250), Dark Lager (81 to 188) and IPL Mosaic (112 to 220) surged. Pint revenue still rose 19%, from \$12,959 to \$15,418, even without Halloween.
- **Check before celebrating.** A halving of the flagship may reflect keg availability rather than taste. Confirm Gold Buckle was on tap all month.
- **Sandwich menu is top-heavy.** Three sandwiches make 89% of sales; PBJ at 1.4% is a candidate to retire.
- **Pretzel cannibalization is still open.** Pretzels appear once in the top 15 (382 with Gold Buckle). Pairing counts cannot show displacement — compare food items per ticket before and after launch.

Recency groups

Active customers are fewer than half the base but worth 2.6× a dormant customer



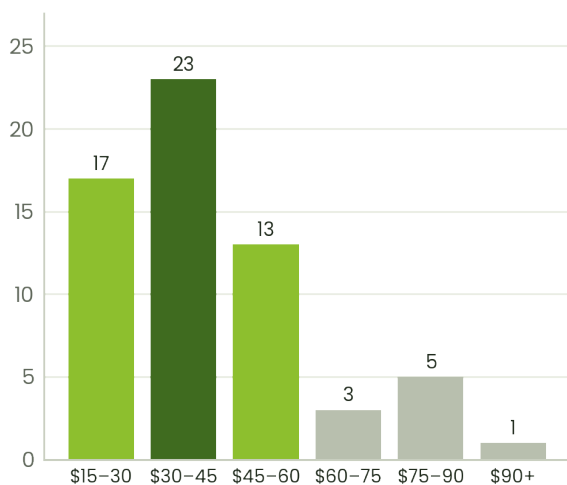
INTERPRETATION

- **Retention is the revenue lever.** The 27 Active customers are 44% of the base but 59% of revenue — about \$4,355 each, versus \$3,011 for Cooling and \$1,650 for Dormant.
- **More than half the base has drifted.** 35 Cooling and Dormant customers have already spent \$82K. If the 18 Cooling customers returned to Active-level spend, that is roughly +\$24K — an illustration of the prize, not a forecast.
- **Tickets are modest.** 65% of customers average under \$45, with \$30–45 the most common band. A promoted beer-and-food pairing is the natural way to add one more item.
- **Revenue is concentrated.** The top two customers account for ~15% of identified revenue and the top nine ~38%. Loyalty perks protect this group, and losing one or two would be visible in a month.

This view covers named customers only. Walk-in tourists are mostly anonymous in Square, so read it as a picture of regulars and locals — the group that, per page 2, is carrying the growth.

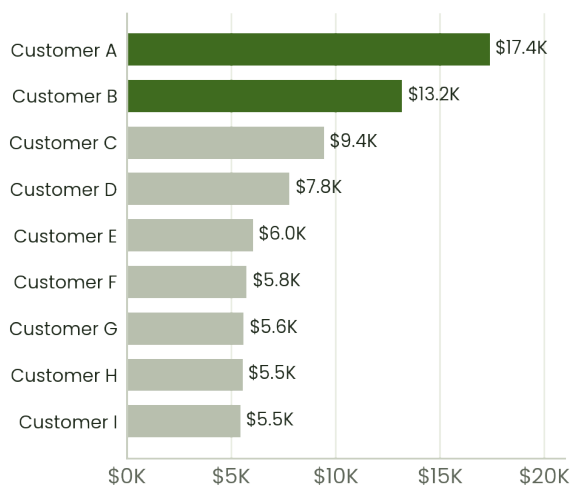
Average purchase value

Number of customers by average ticket



Top customers by total spend

Anonymised · values approximate



SEGMENT PLAYBOOK

Active (27) — protect: loyalty perks, first pour of new releases, recognition for top spenders.

Cooling (18) — win back now: a Mailchimp offer tied to a seasonal release or a pairing special.

Dormant (17) — low-cost reactivation: one 'we miss you' email, then stop spending effort.

Driver scorecard

Evidence strength reflects this dataset, not the driver's importance in general

DRIVER	WHAT THE DATA SHOW	EVIDENCE	SUGGESTED ACTION
Local tourism & seasonality	Sales peaks match Montezuma Castle's spring and fall peaks; summer trough every year	Moderate	Staff and schedule events to Montezuma's calendar; aim locals' promotions at June–August
Growth beyond tourism	Sales up ~34% while park visits fell 8–10%	Strong	Find what changed: bring the Mailchimp, Instagram, Facebook and Yelp data into the analysis
Anchor products & pairings	Gold Buckle in 8 of top 15 pairings; pulled pork, elote, roast beef lead food	Strong	Print pairing suggestions on the menu; trial a bundled price on the top three
Seasonal beer rotation	October pints +19%; Märzen from 1.6% to 13.1% of pint revenue	One month	Plan seasonal releases for shoulder months; confirm Gold Buckle supply in October
Regulars & retention	Active = 59% of revenue; 35 of 62 customers cooling or dormant	Strong (n = 62)	Win-back email to Cooling group; perks for the top spenders
Gas prices	No consistent relationship over 33 months	Weak	Monitor only; revisit if prices stay above ~\$3.80
Pretzel cannibalization	Not testable from the current cuts	Open	Compare food items per ticket before vs. after the pretzel launch

BOTTOM LINE

Tourism sets the rhythm; regulars and the menu set the level.

The seasonal curve follows local visitor traffic, but 2025's step-up happened while that traffic was flat to down. What changed sits inside the taproom: a flagship beer that pairs with the best-selling food, a rotation that widens the mix, and a small group of regulars who spend heavily.

The late-summer slowdown is best read as a hard prior-year base plus a normal seasonal low — not a reversal. The next test is whether October–November 2025 hold above 2024's strong fall.

DATA NOTES & CAVEATS

- Monthly sales, visitor, gas-price and top-customer values were re-read from chart images in the paper (about ±3–5%). Correlations are indicative only. Pairing counts, beer tables, sandwich shares and recency groups are exact.
- The paper dates the slowdown to Aug–Sep **2023**; its charts show it in Aug–Sep **2025** (+20%, -3%), so 2025 is used here. Worth correcting in the paper.
- October excludes Halloween; the customer view covers 62 named customers; 20–33 months of data cannot separate causes that move together.